CHAPTER 16

Alignment with Other Frameworks



This chapter is part of the BLUE reading tour. See Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3, for alternative reading tours.

The TOGAF Standard is the most commonly used framework for developing Enterprise Architectures. Needless to say that organizations also use other types of frameworks and methods to steer the governance of planning and execution, information systems and operation, and management and measurement. In some cases, an organization might even use industry-specific frameworks. It is therefore important to align these existing frameworks and methods with the TOGAF Standard to ensure a solid governance and related outcomes.

16.1. Mapping Existing Frameworks and Methods

In order to align all existing frameworks and methods in an organization, try to answer the following questions:

- Which framework takes precedence?

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- What is the organizational level of commitment on using this framework?
- In what way does the TOGAF Standard fit in?

The main idea behind answering the aforementioned questions is to determine in what way the organization looks at planning, execution, and governance functions. It is useful to get a clear picture of how committed the organization is in using the existing frameworks.



Build the Framework Catalog: Start by compiling a list of all the frameworks the organization uses. These include those for planning and execution, information systems governance and operations, and management and measurement. Don't forget to add industry-specific frameworks that provide insight into business processes and capabilities.

Organize Frameworks by Key Models: Next, group these frameworks according to models such as risk, accounting, and planning. This will help to understand how each framework contributes to different aspects of the organization's operations.

Determine What's Needed from Each Framework: For each framework, identify the specific elements, methods, or techniques that are essential for effectively implementing the recommendations from the Architecture Capability. This ensures that the focus is on what's really needed to achieve the target state.

Assess Organizational Commitment: It's important to recognize how committed the organization is to each framework. Some frameworks may be fully integrated into operations, while others may only be partially adopted. Focus the analysis on the frameworks to which the organization is truly committed, as these will be the most effective in driving meaningful change.

In addition to mapping existing frameworks in the organization to the TOGAF Standard, it is also possible to reverse the approach. This means looking at how other frameworks and methods can connect to the TOGAF Standard. An example of such a connection is given in the next section.

16.2. Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel method is a great example of both the tailorability of the TOGAF Standard and how well the framework allows for alignment with other frameworks and methods.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel method is detailed in my other book, *Getting Started with Enterprise Architecture* [9].

The book describes a practical and pragmatic approach to developing and implementing a fundamental Enterprise Architecture.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel is a practical and pragmatic approach to developing a fundamental Enterprise Architecture. It is based on the TOGAF Standard. The method differs from the framework in that it adapts TOGAF's structure and flow by reorganizing its content into four main stages: Document, Define, Execute, and Control. Each stage is broken down into one or more steps, each of which includes key focus areas and actionable artifacts. This offers organizations a streamlined entry point.

The straightforward description of the steps within the method ensures an accessible approach. The simplicity with which actions and outcomes are described and explained makes the method applicable to almost any situation and scenario.

The method is visually represented by a wheel consisting of a core and three rings (see Figure 16-1).

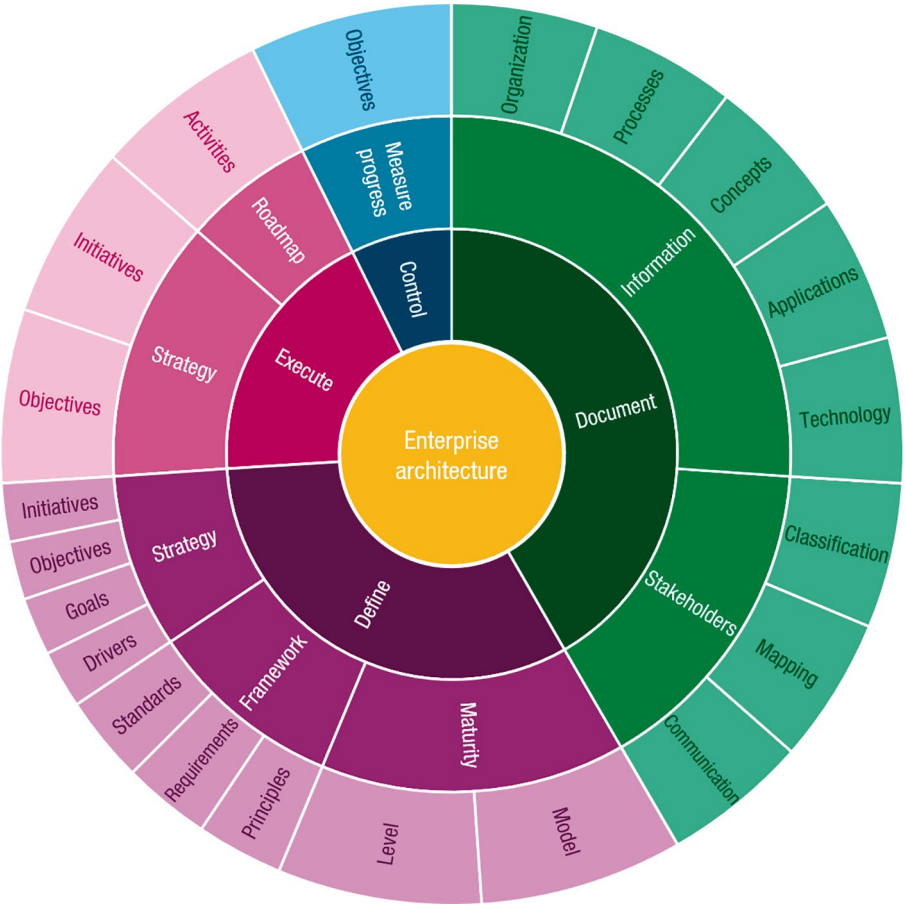


Figure 16-1. *The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel*

The *first ring* around the center is the ring that defines the *four main stages* of the Implementation Wheel. Each stage consists of one or more steps.

The steps form the *second ring* around the center circle and provide valuable information on how to approach each stage. They also define a number of *key focus areas* that are relevant to these steps.

The key focus areas are presented in the *third and final ring* around the center circle. Each of the key focus areas details the various *architectural deliverables* that can be created to complete the previously mentioned steps.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel should preferably be read clockwise, from the inside out. However, an organization may have already gone through an extensive inventory phase and documented everything it does, has, and uses. The organization may want to focus first on translating its strategy into implementation. To accommodate these wishes, the method also supports an iterative approach. This allows for a starting point of choice.

For organizations new to practicing architecture, the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel argues that the approach described in the TOGAF Standard will be even more effective when the sequence of phases (and steps within those phases) is slightly changed. To this end, the method defines four stages:

Document (Stage one): This first stage involves gathering information about the organization and identifying and communicating with key stakeholders. This stage consists of two steps. The first step is to *capture and document the entities of interest* to the organization. The entities are in all architecture domains (Business Architecture, Information Architecture, Application Architecture, and Technology Architecture). The second step of the first stage is to *classify and map the key stakeholders* and *create a Communications Plan*.

Define (Stage two): The *Define* stage focuses on determining the organization's maturity level, principles, and guidelines and outlining its strategy. The stage has three steps. First, it determines the *current and desired maturity* of the Architecture Capability. Second, it describes what

is involved in *establishing basic principles, requirements,* and *standards*[1]. Finally, it focuses on defining the organization's strategy (using the available information). Guidance is provided on how to *determine the drivers, goals,* and *objectives* that the organization is pursuing. It also shows how to identify related *initiatives*.

Execute (Stage three): This stage is about executing the strategy and providing a plan to do so. It consists of two steps. The first step explains how to achieve an *execution of the strategy* defined in the previous stage. This takes into account the previously established goals and objectives. The second step deals with the *creation of a roadmap* based on the objectives to be achieved and the related initiatives and activities.

Control (Stage four): The final stage, *Control*, is concerned with *measuring the progress* of the implementation of a basic Enterprise Architecture. It also explains how to visualize the progress of the realization of the organizational goals and objectives. The initiatives and activities to be carried out are monitored and made measurable. To this end, it discusses a number of measurement tools and techniques that can be used to visualize progress.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel offers a practical and pragmatic approach to implementing a fundamental Enterprise Architecture, rather than a complete one. The method can be thought of as a simplified, tailored version of the TOGAF Standard. It is developed to help organizations get started with architecture, so that they can build on it over time.

[1] The word "standard" refers to particular Solution Building Blocks that further detail specific products or services used to meet requirements. For example, if a principle requires the "use of standard products and services" and a requirement indicates the "use of cloud-based services for commoditized services", a "standard" in this context may refer to "Microsoft Azure web services" or "AWS web services".

16.3.3. Mapping to the Architecture Development Method

All the aforementioned stages, steps, and key focus areas defined in the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel method can be mapped to phases of the Architecture Development Method. Table 16-1 shows the mapping of the first stage (Document) to the ADM.

Table 16-1. *Mapping of Stage one (Document) to the ADM*

Stage	Step	Key Focus Area	ADM Phase
Document	Information	Organization	Phase B
		Processes	Phase B
		Concepts	Phase C
		Applications	Phase C
	Stakeholders	Classification	Phase A
		Mapping	Phase A
		Communication	Phase A

According to the TOGAF Standard, Phase B of the Architecture Development Method is about developing the Baseline and Target Business Architectures that describe how the organization needs to operate to achieve the business goals and respond to the strategic drivers. This aligns with what the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel describes as gaining insight into the organizational structure and its processes.

Phase C directs the organization to, among other things, capture its application portfolio within the Architecture Repository. The same goes for the technology products that are being used. They, too, need to be captured in diagrams and catalogs (during Phase D). Classifying the products during inventory is a welcome addition. The Implementation Wheel supports this approach by emphasizing the importance of its inventory stage.

Finally, Phase A is all about identifying stakeholders and their concerns, as well as knowing how to communicate the architecture with them. To do so correctly, creating a stakeholder mapping based on their classification is essential. The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel addresses all three of these important topics – stakeholder classification, mapping, and communication – during the first stage *(Document)*.

Table 16-2. *Mapping of Stage two (Define) to the ADM*

Stage	Step	Key Focus Area	ADM Phase
Define	Maturity	Model	Phase A
		Level	Phase A
	Framework	Principles	Preliminary Phase
		Requirements	Phases B, C, D
		Standards	Phases B, C, D
	Strategy	Drivers	Preliminary Phase
		Goals	Preliminary Phase
		Objectives	Preliminary Phase
		Initiatives	Preliminary Phase

During the execution of Phase A, a maturity assessment should take place. The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel describes the same need in its second stage (*Define*), but supplements it by providing guidance regarding the use of a maturity model (see Table 16-2).

The TOGAF Standard mentions defining Architecture Principles as being part of the Preliminary Phase. According to the framework, defining a set of Architecture Principles that is appropriate for the organization should be done once the organizational context is understood. The Implementation Wheel therefore suggests performing an inventory of the organization and its context prior to defining the principles.

With regard to strategy, the Preliminary Phase states that strategic and tactical business objectives and aspirations need to be met. The Enterprise Architecture needs to reflect this requirement and enable the architecture discipline to operate within the organization. Using the Implementation Wheel, this requirement is met by following the guidance provided by Business Architecture. The BIZBOK Guide (to which the TOGAF Standard refers) provides useful resources for developing and defining strategic drivers, goals, objectives, and initiatives. The Implementation Wheel adopts this methodology and details how these elements can be implemented.

Table 16-3. *Mapping of Stage three (Execute) to the ADM*

Stage	Step	Key Focus Area	ADM Phase
Execute	Strategy	Objectives	Phase F
		Initiatives	Phase F
	Roadmap	Activities	Phases E, F

The TOGAF Standard implies in Phase F that a business value needs to be assigned to each work package. This allows for focused governance during a later stage. The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel hooks into this during stage three (*Execute*) by detailing the objectives that originated from the organization's strategy into initiatives or work packages (see Table 16-3).

Phase E of the framework describes the creation of an Architecture Roadmap, which is finalized in Phase F. The Architecture Roadmap contains initiatives based on the candidate roadmap items identified during earlier phases. The Implementation Wheel suggests linking the initiatives to their corresponding goals and objectives defined in the second stage (*Define*). This allows for a visually understandable governance in the fourth stage (*Control*).

Table 16-4. *Mapping of Stage four (Control) to the ADM*

Stage	Step	Key Focus Area	ADM Phase
Control	Measure progress	Objectives	Phases G, H

The objective of Phase G is to ensure conformance with the Target Architecture. Priorities are defined and the necessary transitions to reach the Target Architecture are realized. Stage four (*Control*) of the Implementation Wheel provides tools and techniques for measuring and monitoring the progress of these transitions. This aligns with Phase H of the Architecture Development Method (see Table 16-4).

The fourth stage of the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel also enables the architect to prioritize initiatives based on their business value.

The description of the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel clearly shows how easy it is to hook into the TOGAF Standard. The framework described in this book offers tremendous flexibility and adaptability so that it can truly be applied in all kinds of different situations and scenarios.



Further Reading

General information about the alignment with other frameworks can be found in the "The TOGAF® Leader's Guide to Establishing and Evolving an EA Capability" Series Guide, document number G168.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel is described in more detail in the book *Getting Started with Enterprise Architecture* (ISBN 9781484298572) and at the following URL:

https://eawheel.com/wheel/

16.4. Summary

When it comes to developing Enterprise Architectures, the TOGAF Standard stands out as the most commonly used framework. It is often the go-to choice for organizations. However, these organizations also employ other frameworks. Therefore, aligning these existing frameworks with the TOGAF Standard becomes crucial.

To successfully achieve this alignment, it's essential to determine which framework takes precedence, understand the organizational commitment to existing frameworks, and identify how the TOGAF Standard can integrate seamlessly. Addressing these considerations helps clarify how the organization approaches planning, execution, and governance functions. This understanding reveals how the TOGAF Standard can complement existing frameworks, providing a solid foundation for developing and implementing an Enterprise Architecture.

Beyond mapping existing frameworks to the TOGAF Standard, it's also possible to reverse the approach – examining how other frameworks can connect to the TOGAF Standard.

The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel exemplifies both the tailorability of the TOGAF Standard and its capability for alignment with other frameworks and methods. The Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel largely follows the TOGAF Standard but distinguishes itself by adapting the sequence of steps (or phases) in architecture development. All stages, steps, and key focus areas defined in the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel can be easily mapped to phases of the Architecture Development Method.

The description of the Enterprise Architecture Implementation Wheel demonstrates how effortlessly it integrates with the TOGAF Standard. The framework described in this book offers remarkable flexibility and adaptability, making it applicable across various situations and scenarios.